

Area of Study 1 – Instrumental Music 1700-1820

The pieces selected as set works provide a good representation of instrumental music from the period 1700–1820. The Bach Brandenburg Concerto no. 5, 3rd movement includes a study of fugue in a Gigue dance movement. General features of Baroque music can be analysed in this piece. The Beethoven Piano Sonata no. 8 in C minor is chosen as an example of solo instrumental music. It is a dramatic romantic work in sonata form.

The suggested wider listening works provide a good background and context to the set pieces. The Handel Concerto Grosso complements the Bach work and the Vivaldi Winter from the Four Seasons provides further study of the solo concerto form. The Classical piano sonata movements by Mozart and Haydn provide a good historical introduction to the piano sonata as a genre and prepare for the extended Beethoven sonata movement.